

The Battle of Gonzales

Decide whether a small skirmish over a cannon — the 'Come and Take It' fight of October 2, 1835 — was truly the turning point that began the Texas Revolution.

? Historical challenge

On October 2, 1835, Texian colonists at Gonzales refused to hand a small cannon back to Mexican soldiers and fired on them instead, under a homemade flag reading 'Come and Take It.' Almost no one was hurt — so why do historians call this the turning point that began the Texas Revolution? Map what led up to it and what changed afterward.

1 Investigate

SOURCES 1

Gonzales, Battle of — Handbook of Texas Online (TSHA)

SECONDARY SOURCE

The Texas State Historical Association's entry on the opening battle of the Revolution.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- What was the dispute really about?
- Why was it important even though few were hurt?

SOURCES 2

Gonzales 'Come and Take It' Cannon — Handbook of Texas Online (TSHA)

SECONDARY SOURCE

The story of the loaned cannon and the 'Come and Take It' flag made by the women of Gonzales.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- Why did the colonists care so much about one small cannon?
- What did the flag's message mean?

SOURCES 3

First shots of the Texas Revolution fired in the Battle of Gonzales (HISTORY)

SECONDARY SOURCE

A short account of the skirmish and its minimal casualties.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- How many people were hurt in the fight?
- How can an event be important without being big?

2 Build your Event Map

Fill in the organizer from the evidence. Mark information with ①②③ to show which source it came from. Leave a space blank if the sources don't tell you.

BEFORE	Who pushed toward this point?
↓	
PRESSURES BUILDING	Who resisted?
↓	
TURNING POINT Battle of Gonzales ('Come and Take It') · October 2, 1835	Could events have gone differently?
↓	
IMMEDIATE RESULTS	
↓	
LONGER-TERM CHANGE	
Why could this be a turning point?	

Sources 1 Sources 2 Sources 3

3 Compare

- Compare your before-and-after with a partner. Did you agree on what changed most?
- Which pressure do you think mattered most in pushing events toward a fight?

4 Expand

Your teacher will add context, vocabulary, and information the sources leave out. Add it to your map.

5 Revise

Go back to your Event Map. Add, correct, or reorganize based on the discussion.

6 Conclude

Was the Battle of Gonzales truly a turning point? Use evidence from at least two sources to argue what changed after it that could not be undone.